

# CHINA

A country of mountainous tea regions, China invented tea drinking thousands of years ago and everything we now know about growing tea was first learned from the Chinese.

China is the world's largest tea producer but, as most is consumed domestically, relatively little is available for export. This has driven adventurous tea retailers in the West to develop close ties with Chinese tea growers to obtain premium teas for their customers.

China produces the greatest variety of teas of anywhere in the world and its tea makers are extremely knowledgeable about tea growing and production, largely because they have been manufacturing tea for over 4,000 years. Tea is still mostly plucked

by hand and only produced using the orthodox method (see p21). Manufacturers may deviate from the usual production steps to create their own unique style of tea, which is often the case with small productions of green tea.

Although many Chinese producers are only associated with particular teas from their region, many are experimenting with other teas, for example, creating black (red) teas from cultivars that are usually made into green tea, or growing the Japanese Yabukita cultivar destined for Matcha production.

ASIA



Anji Bai Cha



## CHINA KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE OF WORLD PRODUCTION **36.8%**

ELEVATION: **MEDIUM TO HIGH**

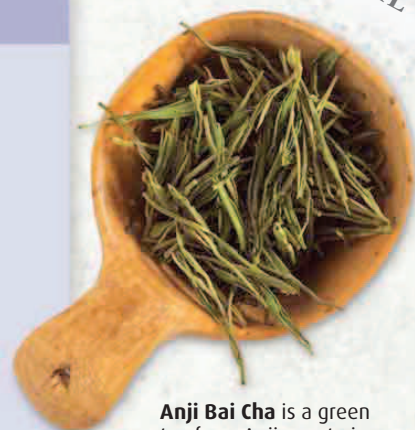
OTHER TEA-PRODUCING PROVINCES:

**ANHUI** GUANGDONG, HUBEI

MAIN TYPES: **GREEN, OOLONG, WHITE, BLACK, PU'ER, YELLOW**

HARVEST: **MARCH-MAY**

WORLD RANKING AS A PRODUCER: **WORLD'S LARGEST TEA PRODUCER**



**Anji Bai Cha** is a green tea from Anji county in the Zhejiang province. Although "Bai" means "white" in Chinese, the tea is named after the light color of its unplucked leaf.